



VARIOUS PROTOTYPES fill a large room at the Irvine headquarters of electric vehicle maker Rivian. CHRISTINA HOUSE Los Angeles Times

German far right targets voting by mail

Echoing Trump, the move precedes an election that could break a postwar taboo.

By ERIK KIRSCHBAUM

BERLIN — Leaders of an extremist, far-right party in Germany have quietly borrowed pages from President Trump’s playbook to cast doubt on the integrity of absentee voting — alleging without evidence that residents of nursing homes have had their ballots manipulated and calling for an end to postal voting.

The attack on mail ballots comes as Germany approaches a potentially historic state election that could shatter one of the taboos of its postwar political order by opening the door to a far-right government.

Politicians across the ideological spectrum, mindful that polls show Trump to be widely unpopular, don’t invoke his name.

But the specter of the American president nevertheless hangs over the election that could have reverberations across Europe if the Alternative for Germany, or AfD, party — tacitly echoing Trump’s attacks on migrants, the media and the integrity of elections — pulls off an unprecedented political shock in postwar Germany.

In a country where the guilt of its Nazi past is never far from the surface, the AfD has unapologetically campaigned against what it portrays as the shackles of Germany’s history and won over many new supporters, in part by adopting Trump’s hard-line stance on migrants and his drumbeat of attacks on mainstream news outlets.

The AfD leader, Tino Chrupalla, surprised Germans recently with warnings of voter fraud in the Sunday election in Saxony-Anhalt state, telling a national television audience that some senior citizens in nursing homes had had their absentee ballots cast and signed for them without their knowledge.

This week, in neighboring Mecklenburg-Vorpommern state, the AfD candidate for governor, Leif-Erik Holm, declared, “Postal voting is more vulnerable to potential attempts of manipulation.”

Election officials and organizations representing nursing home caregivers have rejected the allegations and say there is no evidence of voter fraud.

[See Germany, A3]

EV growth persists despite federal curbs

Trump has eroded California’s emissions rules, yet nearly 1 in 6 new cars sold are electric

By HAYLEY SMITH

California’s transition to electric vehicles is still underway, with more chargers for cars and trucks, more models to choose from and more ambitious sales targets. But it is increasingly shaped by what’s happening on the other side of the country, in Washington, where the federal government is working to slow the transition to EVs and promote a fossil fuel future for America.

The pace of this transition matters for the state’s climate goals, including reaching carbon neutrality by 2045 and getting more gas-powered cars off the road. It’s impossible to address climate change without these since transportation accounts for about half of the state’s greenhouse gas emissions, more than any other sector.

In recent months, President Trump has taken dozens of steps to erode California’s ability to get there. They include eliminating the federal tax credit for people who purchase EVs and repealing the

basic finding that greenhouse gases are dangerous, which forms the legal basis for regulating vehicle emissions under the Clean Air Act.

Last year, the Trump administration revoked California’s long-held authority to set stricter vehicle emission standards than the federal government — an authority that has been granted to the state since the 1960s. The White House also overturned California’s electric vehicle sales target, which would have required automakers to sell an increasing percentage of zero-emission vehicles over the next decade.

The president has said the state’s rules will drive up costs and limit consumer choice.

The cumulative result is a slower shift to EVs, by several measures.

National sales dropped sharply after Trump ended the \$7,500 federal rebate in September and have not yet fully recovered.

[See EVs, A12]

For Walter, hardball is new

Dodgers owner has kept low profile and built loyalty

By KEVIN BAXTER

A few months after Mark Walter became the chairman and majority owner of the Dodgers, he was told a fan in one of Dodger Stadium’s upper decks was upset about a mix-up with his tickets.

On most days, that would be an issue for an usher to handle. Not on this day.

Walter and team president Stan Kasten decided to address the problem, climbing the narrow stairwell to the top level where they found the fan and listened to his complaint.



MICHAEL REAVES Getty Images
MARK Walter is selling the Lakers amid scrutiny over his business deals.

“Obviously the guy was floored just to see me, let alone to see Mark,” Kasten said. “Mark, he’s incredibly comfortable around people. Not just his peers, but average fans. Because he considers himself an average fan.”

The Dodgers’ billionaire owner, hardly an average fan, is under intense scrutiny these days, following the sale of his controlling interest in the Lakers and a federal investigation into his business dealings. The drama has come as a surprise to some who know Walter, who has earned respect for his financial acumen and,

[See Walter, A9]

Pershing Square renamed for local heroine

The Los Angeles City Council voted Friday to rename Pershing Square after Bridget “Biddy” Mason, who was born into slavery and went on to become a wealthy landowner and a founder of the city’s First African Methodist Episcopal Church, one of the nation’s largest Black churches.

The council’s unanimous vote directs city officials to begin the process of renaming the five-acre plaza near the Biltmore Hotel as Biddy Mason Park. The Rev. Timothy E. Tyler of the First AME Church was among those urging the council to approve the change.

“In a world where histories are being erased and denied or negated, we believe that this act by the City Council will signal to the world that we in Los Angeles value those who have helped to build this city,” Tyler said. Councilmember Ysabel

Biddy Mason, First AME Church founder, gets her flowers from city

By SANDRA McDONALD



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times
PERSHING SQUARE was first renamed in 1918 for a World War I general with little connection to L.A.

Rising diesel prices weigh on small business

As Iran war disrupts supply chains, farmers and trucking fleets struggle with cost.

By CLARA HARTER AND SUHAUNA HUSSAIN

In late summer, when almond husks split open, workers at Creekside Farming in Madera gear up machinery to shake the trees. Tractors zoom around, fallen nuts are collected, and trucks cart off the bins of almonds.

The whole process relies on diesel fuel, which has grown extremely expensive in recent months, said farm owner Jay Mahil, whose family has been growing wine grapes, citrus and other crops in the Central Valley for four generations.

The national average price of diesel hit a new record high of \$5.85 per gallon Friday, while California’s average climbed to about \$7.71, according to the AAA motor club.

The oil product undergirds much of the global economy, and California, a major player, is no exception to the pain caused by ongoing supply chain disruptions stemming from the U.S. war with Iran.

The higher fuel costs are

squeezing businesses across various industries in California, which has massive trucking and agricultural sectors that rely heavily on diesel to power equipment.

Mahil said his fuel costs are up 40% from this time last year.

“These higher costs come at the worst time for us,” Mahil said. “These are highly inundated time frames.”

Mahil keeps a close eye on prices. When there’s an occasional slump or dip in the oil market, he orders several truckloads of fuel. But other businesses usually have the same idea, and the fuel depots often run out those days.

“We are running a little leaner right now, with less oil in the tanks,” Mahil said.

California diesel prices set a record earlier on in the war, at around \$7.75 per gallon in April.

Greg Dubuque, general manager for a trucking fleet based out of Montebello, noted that the cost to fill his trucks in California has gone from around \$1,200 in April to \$1,800.

“It’s a dramatic impact, especially for us smaller companies,” he said.

Gene Seroka, executive director of the Port of Los Angeles, said more than two-thirds of cargo moving in and out of the port is

[See Diesel, A7]

Olympic plan will restrict freeways

Hundreds of miles of traffic lanes will be reserved for athletes and other visitors.

By SALVADOR HERNANDEZ

Hundreds of miles of freeways and streets across Southern California will be turned into restricted roadways for exclusive use by permit holders during the 2028 Olympics under a plan to ensure smooth travel for visitors, athletes and staff in a region notorious for heavy traffic, according to reports and drafts of the project reviewed by The Times.

The restricted lanes are expected to include major freeways that cut across Los Angeles, Orange and San Diego counties and connect game venues with the Olympic villages, where athletes and coaches will stay.

Instead of navigating congested freeways and roads, those granted exclusive permits would be allowed to cut through traffic

under what is known as the 2028 Olympic “Games Route Network.”

The network is expected to include about 236 miles of carpool and restricted lanes on busy freeways, and about 134 miles along local streets, according to a map of the proposed plan drafted by the California Department of Transportation.

“It’s really specific to transporting athletes,” said Annie Nam, deputy director of planning and transportation for the Southern California Assn. of Governments, one of the groups working to put in place the regional plan for the Olympic Games.

“It’s a dedicated network to make sure that athletes can get to their competition on time.”

About 40 venues across Southern California are expected to host events during the 2028 Games, and the UCLA campus is set to become the main village for housing the athletes. The Games Route Network is planned to help athletes, coaches, Olympic workers

[See Olympics, A9]

Jury deadlocks in murder trial

Judge declares mistrial in mother’s killing of children, a case that has divided jurors and the nation. **NATION, A6**

‘I wouldn’t call it a war,’ VP says

Vance rejects the term to describe the hostilities with Iran. Trump calls them “small potatoes.” **WORLD, A2**

Olympics could displace 5,975

Many Unhoused people in L.A. may be uprooted by 2028 Games, a preliminary study finds. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Weather

Partly sunny. L.A. Basin: 87°/71. **B8**

